**PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS**
**OFFICE OF TECHNOLOGY AND INFORMATION SERVICES (OTIS)**
**Business and Operations**
501 North Dixon Street / Portland, OR 97227
Telephone: (503) 916-3380 / Fax: (503) 916-3050

**Date:** October 11, 2026

**To:** PPS Board of Education

**From:** Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent
Dr. Kristin Moon, Director, Educator Professional Learning
Russell Adamson, Sr. Director, Office of Technology & Information Services
Mark Lancaster, Director, Office of Technology & Information Services

**Subject:** Response to GenAI Pause as requested at June 23rd BOE Meeting

# Executive Summary

This memorandum serves as the districtwide assessment requested by the Board of Education on June 23, 2026 via the Budget Amendment “AI Pause REVISED” within Resolution 7326.

As directed, this response documents the approved applications and software systems currently in operation utilizing GenAI across central office and instructional environments, establishes updated governance standards, and formalizes our recommendations for future digital literacy and technology use.

# Definitions

- **Artificial Intelligence (AI):** The capability of computer systems or algorithms to imitate intelligent human behavior.
- **Generative AI (GenAI):** Artificial intelligence that is capable of generating new content (such as images or text) in response to a submitted prompt by learning from a large reference database of examples.
- **Agentic AI:** Able to accomplish results with autonomy, used especially in reference to artificial intelligence.

# Resolution Directive Compliance

Below is the detailed response to the June 23 Board Resolution. Per the Amendment language, **"*This pause shall not apply to cybersecurity, accessibility, or software maintenance functions that do not materially expand GenAI capabilities and/or are not student-interactive.*"**

| Resolution Directive | Status | Detailed Response |
|---|---|---|
| (1) "Pause the execution of any new contracts, contract amendments, subscriptions, pilot programs, software licenses, or procurement actions primarily related to GenAI technologies" | Compliant | ● At the time of the resolution, none of the activity listed was planned<br>● No change since the time of resolution<br>● Lumi and Amira contracts expired on June 30, 2026 |
| (2) "Pause the expansion of existing GenAI technology implementations beyond their current scope of work" | Compliant | ● At the time of the resolution, none of the activity listed was planned<br>● No change since the time of resolution<br>● Lumi and Amira contracts expired on June 30, 2026 |
| (3) "Prepare an Inventory of ***(approved)*** Existing Student-Facing GenAI Implementations" | Listed | ● At the time of the resolution, two (2) GenAI applications were approved - Lumi and Amira none of the activity listed was planned<br>● Both the Lumi and Amira contracts expired on June 30, 2026<br>● Currently, there are no approved GenAI classroom applications |
| (4) "Work to amend all existing educational technology contracts and data-sharing agreements to prohibit third-party vendors from collecting or sharing personally identifiable student data unless expressly required by law." | Compliant | ● All approved software (instructional or otherwise) has strong FERPA language within every Tech Services Agreement<br>● ***NOTE:*** PPS Academics, OTIS, & Legal ***recommend*** stronger Policy language to reduce or eliminate **unapproved** software in the classroom, as it does not follow approved vetting and procurement processes and controls. |

| Resolution Directive | Status | Detailed Response |
|---|---|---|
| (5) “Provide, within 90 days of adoption of this Resolution, a comprehensive districtwide assessment of all AI systems, contracts, expenditures, pilot programs, data-sharing agreements, risk mitigation measures, and educational impacts; that includes, at a minimum” | | |
| (a) An inventory of all GenAI tools, platforms, software products, pilots, and services currently utilized throughout PPS | Complete | ● **Classroom & Instructional** - Currently, there are no approved GenAI classroom applications<br>● **Central Office** - please see section below titled *“Central Office GenAI Inventory”* |
| (b) All associated contracts, costs, funding sources, and renewal dates | Complete | ● **Classroom & Instructional** - Currently, there are no approved GenAI classroom applications<br>● **Central Office** - this is a significant effort to collect & summarize data. This summary will be delivered in advance of 11/4 BOE meeting |
| (c) A description of all student, employee, and PPS data shared with associated vendors | Complete | ● All approved software (instructional orL otherwise) has strong FERPA language as part of every Technology Services Agreement<br>● ***NOTE: PPS Academics, OTIS, & Legal departments recommend*** stronger Policy or Administrative Directive language to reduce or eliminate **unapproved** software in the classroom, as it does not follow approved vetting and procurement processes and controls. |
| (d) Recommendations regarding future implementation, limitations, or expansion of GenAI technologies within PPS | Complete | ● Please see section below titled *“Promoting Balanced Instruction and Healthy Technology Use”* |

# Classroom & Instructional Technology Landscape

Within the instructional scope, there are 54 total core curriculum (Language Arts, Social Studies, Mathematics, and Science) applications:

- **Approved Non-GenAI Core Curriculum Apps: 34**
- **Approved Teacher-Facing GenAI Apps: 20**
- **Approved Instructional (Student-Facing) GenAI apps: 0**

Approved apps utilized for Career and Technical Education (CTE) follow the standard app vetting approval process and align directly to industry standards for specific CTE programming.

# Central Office GenAI Inventory

PPS has 720 total approved technology tools (this includes the 54 listed above). This inventory lists applications with documented GenAI capabilities currently in use by Central Office staff. Below are the In compliance with Directive 5b and 5c, all associated costs, renewal dates, and descriptions of shared data have been documented.

## Productivity Tools

- **Google Workspace/Gemini & Gemini Notebook**
  - *Vendor:* Google, Inc. | *Office:* OTIS
  - *Deployment:* 1,926 active staff accounts
  - *Cost & Renewal:* Included at $6/user/year with Staff license ($224k total estimate) | Renews 1/26/2027
  - *Data Shared:* Employee credentials, email metadata, user-generated prompts, non-sensitive administrative documents.
  - *Links:* https://edu.google.com/intl/ALL_us/ai/gemini-for-education/, https://support.google.com/gemininotebook/answer/17004255?hl=en
- **Smartsheet**
  - *Vendor:* Smartsheet, Inc. | *Office:* OTIS
  - *Deployment:* 143 active seats (central office)
  - *Cost & Renewal:* $165k (General Funds) | Renews 7/15/2027
  - *Data Shared:* Administrative project schedules, operational workflows, employee project data.
  - *Links:* https://www.smartsheet.com/ai
- **AXIS3**
  - *Vendor:* Creatively Focused | *Office:* Special Education
  - *Deployment:* 435 staff accounts
  - *Cost & Renewal:* $136k (General Funds) | Renewal TBD
  - *Data Shared:* Special education operational workflows and anonymized procedural

support metrics.
    - *Links:* https://creativelyfocused.net/education-solutions

## Infrastructure & Operations

- **CIM Peak Fault Detection and Diagnostics**
    - *Vendor:* CIM | *Office:* Facilities Maintenance
    - *Deployment:* 5 staff (25 modernized buildings)
    - *Cost & Renewal:* Included in enterprise base licensing / TBD
    - *Data Shared:* Facility HVAC performance metrics, building sensor telemetry.
    - *Links:* https://www.cim.io/solutions/fault-detection-and-diagnostics
- **Workato Automation Platform / Snowflake / AWS Connect Customer / Catalyst Center**
    - *Vendors:* Workato, Snowflake, AWS, Cisco | *Office:* OTIS
    - *Deployment:* Back-office network and automation administrators (5-10 staff per system)
    - *Cost & Renewal:* Integrated into core enterprise licensing and Capital/General Funds / TBD
    - *Data Shared:* System logs, network routing telemetry, back-office API payloads, IT contact center audio/routing metrics.

## Cybersecurity & Content Filtering

- **Falcon Complete**
    - *Vendor:* Crowdstrike, Inc. | *Office:* OTIS
    - *Cost & Renewal:* $419k (Capital Funds) | Renews 4/1/2028
    - *Data Shared:* Device telemetry, application execution logs, threat intelligence data.
    - *Links:* https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/solutions/falcon-complete-for-falcon-guardian/
- **Inbound Email Security, AI Security Mailbox**
    - *Vendor:* Abnormal AI, Inc. | *Office:* OTIS
    - *Cost & Renewal:* $133k (Capital Funds) | Renews 12/29/2028
    - *Data Shared:* Incoming district email headers, text, and routing metadata for threat analysis.
    - *Links:* https://abnormal.ai/platform/inbound-email-security
- **Securly Filter / Umbrella Secure Access / Security Cloud**
    - *Vendors:* Securly, Inc., Cisco | *Office:* OTIS
    - *Cost & Renewal:* Securly at $82k (Capital Funds) renewing 11/15/2026. Cisco systems integrated into enterprise infrastructure.
    - *Data Shared:* Network traffic destinations, blocked content requests, system web filtering logs.
    - *Links:* https://www.securly.com/filter, https://umbrella.cisco.com/products/umbrella-enterprise-security-packages

# Promoting Balanced Instruction & Healthy Tech Use

## I. Definitions

**A. Screen Time:** Screen Time refers to the amount of time a student is expected to view or interact with Device displays, including structured educational technology used for instruction and unstructured or non-instructional media. Screen Time does not include use of assistive technology required to provide a student with access to instruction or PPS services.

**B. Device:** As used in this policy, a Device means any PPS-owned, PPS-issued, or PPS-managed laptop, desktop computer, tablet, mobile phone, wearable device, virtual or augmented reality equipment, or other internet-connected hardware used to access PPS systems or instructional content.

**C. Educational Technology:** Educational Technology means software, digital applications, online services, websites, platforms, and other digital tools used for instructional, assessment, accessibility, safety, communication, or administrative purposes.

**D. Approved Educational Technology:** Approved Educational Technology means Educational Technology that PPS has reviewed and authorized under its educational technology approval process.

## II. Objective

PPS will use educational technology when it supports a defined instructional, accessibility, safety, or operational purpose. Educators should select instructional methods best suited to the learning objective and provide developmentally appropriate opportunities for discussion, handwriting, reading in print, physical activity, collaborative work, creative expression, independent problem-solving, and other screen-free learning. Educational Technology should support, rather than routinely replace, effective educator-led instruction and interpersonal learning.

## III. Grade-Level Technology Restrictions

### A. Pre-K Through 8th Grade

i. PPS will limit use of PPS-issued Devices during instructional time in accordance with the PPS Screen Time Guidelines for PPS adopted curriculum and assessments:

Pre-Kindergarten-Grade 2: Up to 130 minutes per week, inclusive of core instruction and intervention

Grades 3-5: Up to 225 minutes per week inclusive of core instruction and intervention

Grades 6-8: Up to 300 minutes per week across all classes

ii. Devices will be used to support specific in-class curriculum and learning activities and will not serve the primary instructional medium. PPS will not operate a standard one-to-one take-home Device program for students in Pre-K through Grade 8.

iii. Students may take PPS Devices home only to address an identified instructional, accessibility, equity, or academic-support need, as approved by the principal or designee, or as required by an individualized education program ("IEP"), Section 504 plan, or applicable law. PPS will provide the student's parent or guardian with notice of the take-home arrangement and obtain an acknowledgment of applicable Device-use requirements. Failure to return an acknowledgment will not prevent PPS from providing a Device when the Device is required to provide the student with equal access, appropriate services, or legally required accommodations.

**B. High School**

i. PPS will limit use of PPS-issued Devices during instructional time in accordance with PPS Screen Time Guidelines. Use must support a defined instructional, assessment, accessibility, safety, or operational purpose. Educators should incorporate appropriate screen-free instruction and activities based on the learning objective and students' developmental needs.

ii. PPS Devices will be issued to each student.

## IV. Content and Platforms Across All Grade Levels

**A. Streaming Restrictions:** Classroom access to streaming media is limited to content that supports an instructional purpose and is selected by an educator through an Approved Educational Technology service. PPS will use industry-standard filtering and monitoring tools to block restricted content across platforms.

Staff may not require or direct students to create accounts, disclose personal information, upload student work, or use an educational technology service unless the service has been approved through the PPS educational technology review process. Staff may not accept click-through terms on behalf of PPS or use free applications, browser extensions, pilot programs, or artificial intelligence tools unless authorized under that process.

**B. Responsible Use Policy:** Consistent with the Responsible Use Policy, use of PPS Devices, accounts, networks, and systems may be monitored for legitimate educational, safety, security, legal, and operational purposes. Automated alerts or classifications will receive appropriate human review before being used for discipline, grading, special-education decisions, or other material decisions affecting a student. Students using PPS Devices, accounts, or networks will have no expectation of privacy.

## V. Operational Accountability

**A. EdTech Audit:** PPS will conduct an annual review of all educational technology contracts and, to the extent feasible, conduct an assessment of unapproved digital technology use and report to the Board the results of the review.

**B. Evaluation of Impact of Technology Application Use:** PPS will develop a plan for the adoption of digital technology used for instruction.

## VI. Digital Literacy

PPS will integrate developmentally appropriate Digital Literacy instruction into the core curriculum for grades K–12. This instruction will focus on:

A. Evaluating source credibility and detecting misinformation;

B. Understanding data privacy and the Responsible Use Policy;

C. The environmental and social impacts of digital technologies;

D. Safe and respectful use of digital tools;

E. Skills to critically evaluate digital content;

F. Developing critical thinking, creativity, communication, collaboration, empathy, judgment, and independent problem-solving skills in a rapidly evolving technological world; and

G. Maintaining healthy technology habits, including attention management, periodic breaks, ergonomics, and awareness of persuasive or engagement-focused design.

## VI. Professional Learning

All PPS staff members will complete annual training about data privacy, security, and responsible use to ensure alignment with this policy, the Children's Online Privacy Protect Act (COPPA), and the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA).

### VII. Exceptions

The restrictions and limits provided in Section III of this Administrative Directive and the PPS Screentime Guidelines may be modified to be consistent with students' IEPs or Section 504 Plans based on individual students' disability-related needs as determined by their IEP or 504 teams.

# Recommendations for Future Implementation

To ensure PPS remains secure, compliant, and educationally effective, we formally recommend the following strategic initiatives:

1. **Instructional Staff Professional Development:** Cross-functional collaboration between OTIS and Academic teams to design and deliver targeted professional learning. This will focus on literacy, critical thinking, data privacy, and instructional strategies to prepare staff for evolving technological realities. This effort requires funds which need to be sustained over multiple fiscal years.

2. **Development and Implementation of Digital Literacy**: Student-facing digital literacy lessons that include critical evaluation of technological outputs, ethical use, and understanding bias.

3. **Back-Office Modernization:** Continue leveraging non-student-interactive AI within approved back-office infrastructure (e.g., cybersecurity, Workday platform evolution, filtering). Restricting administrative modernizations poses a severe risk of reduced central services and unsustainable organic staff growth.

4. **Parent & Community Engagement:** Deepen partnerships with parent and family advocacy groups (such as Schools Beyond Screens) to amplify shared goals surrounding digital literacy and healthy technology usage outside the traditional school day.

5. **Regular Updates to Board, Administrative Directives and AI Guidebook:** Brief the Board three times a year on the current state and future roadmap of district technology, updating PPS Administrative Directives and the AI Guidebook on the same schedule.